

Shaping India's Next Urban Chapter: Mallanna Sasalu on Building Sustainable, Future-Ready Cities



Real estate a critical enabler to creating resilient urban communities

As India enters its next phase of economic expansion, the way cities are planned and built is under sharper focus. For Mallanna Sasalu, CEO, Puravankara Limited, the future of real estate lies in achieving scale with discipline, delivering large, integrated developments that combine housing, infrastructure, and community life while ensuring quality, sustainability, and trust remain uncompromised.

Mallanna's perspective is shaped by a career spanning real estate development, private equity, and asset management across Asia-Pacific and North America. With experience across residential, commercial, hospitality, and mixed-use assets totalling more than USD 1 billion, he brings a global lens to India's urban challenge of building cities that grow rapidly yet remain liveable, inclusive, and resilient.

At Puravankara Limited, a nearly five-decade-old institution headquartered in Bengaluru, Mallanna plays a central role in steering the company's overall busi-

ness. Having delivered over 55 million sq ft across nine cities, Puravankara is particularly recognised for large-format townships that go beyond housing to create complete ecosystems. For Mallanna, trust is foundational, especially in an industry where customers invest life savings based on belief, long before they can physically experience the product.

He consistently emphasises end-user-led demand as the foundation of sustainable scale. This is reflected in Puravankara's focus on integrated townships located near employment hubs, with access to healthcare, schools, retail, and everyday societal needs. Strategic land acquisition, calibrated density, and long-term infrastructure planning underpin developments that reduce commute stress and improve quality of life.

Customer obsession defines Mallanna's leadership philosophy. He believes that selling homes based on promises and narratives creates a moral responsibility to deliver more than just shelter. Under

his leadership, townships are designed with a human-centric lens, open spaces, parks, community centres, walkable streets, and shared amenities that foster interaction, safety, and belonging across generations, from toddlers to senior citizens.

Sustainability is embedded at the core of this township-led approach. Mallanna views environmental responsibility not as compliance, but as a strategic imperative. Water stewardship, energy efficiency, green cover, and climate-responsive design are integrated at the planning stage to ensure developments remain relevant and resilient over decades.

Equally central is governance and capital discipline in a cyclical industry. Mallanna believes enduring leadership in real estate requires scale backed by balance-sheet strength, operational rigour, and transparent stakeholder engagement, allowing large townships to be executed responsibly across market cycles.

A civil engineer by training and an alumnus of Harvard Business School, Mallanna combines technical depth with financial acumen across the full development lifecycle, from land strategy and funding to execution and asset management. His multicultural experience enables him to align large-scale developments with broader economic and social priorities.

Looking ahead, Mallanna believes that building integrated townships at scale is inseparable from nation-building. As India's cities expand, he sees real estate as a critical enabler, creating self-sustaining urban communities that are resilient, inclusive, future-ready, and worthy of the trust millions place in them.

